

JERUSALEM ARTICHOKE

Helianthus tuberosus

A relative of the sunflower, Jerusalem artichokes are tall and stately plants that can produce bright yellow sunflowerlike blooms. The knobby tubers develop in the soil among the roots, and can be eaten raw or cooked, but beware—they are notorious for producing flatulence. Don't be put off, since the tubers are a delicious vegetable.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
PLANT				
HARVEST				

PLANTING TUBERS

Jerusalem artichokes will grow almost anywhere as long as the soil is not waterlogged, but they prefer alkaline conditions so add lime to the soil if its pH is below 5. Plants can grow to about 10 ft (3 m) tall, so site them carefully—they could be grown to form natural screens or windbreaks. Either obtain tubers fresh from a greengrocer, or use saved tubers from previous years. Apply a medium-fertility soil improver before planting to encourage larger tubers.

Plant when the soil has warmed up in early spring. Dig a drill 4–6 in (10–15 cm) deep and place tubers along it at intervals of 12–18 in (30–45 cm), before covering over with soil.



The vibrant flowers add a splash of color.

CROP CARE

Weed well, and water during dry spells. Plants will need to be earthed up as they grow, with about 1.5–4 in (4–10 cm) of soil, and then supported with canes or wires. This provides the tall stems with stability, which is especially useful if they are planted in an exposed or windy position. In mid- to late summer cut the plant down to 5 ft (1.5 m),